Fangyuan (Sam) Cao

Miramonte High School, 2026

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My LinkedIn Profile

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Enrichment Programs

Leadership in the Business World @ the Wharton School (UPenn)

Summer after 11th grade

Selected for a four-week, residential business immersion program. Engaged in lectures on finance, marketing, and entrepreneurship, management, and co-developed a case presentation for faculty judges. Led my team to win 3rd out of 23 groups in the final case competition.

Berkeley Business Academy Academic Year (B-BAY) @ UC Berkeley Haas

During 11th grade

Selected for a two-semester, project-based entrepreneurship incubator. Conducted customer discovery, validated a business model, and built operating/financial plans for an AI college counseling service.

California State Summer School for the Arts (CSSSA) @ California Institute of the Arts

Summer after 9th grade

Selected to participate in a rigorous, month-long program pursuing intensive studio training in drawing, painting and digital media.

Experiences

Co-Founder, Co-President, and Editor-in-Chief

Academus Club and Journal

11th - Present

- Lead bi-weekly philosophy lectures on topics such as ethics, epistemology, and religion; ~25 attendees per meeting.
- Founded and manage Academus Journal for the Social Sciences and Humanities.
- Published 2 issues (representing 15 papers) and streamlined a double-blind peer-review workflow. Third issue is forthcoming.

Chief Operating Officer

NC Tutoring

10th - 11th

- Implemented reforms to organizational structure, which resulted in a 30% increase in the number of tutors and students.
- Helped launch the pen pal project, which connected native English speakers with ~20 ESL students.
- Launched an online store to aid organization fundraising efforts.
- Transitioned out to focus on academics and other extracurricular commitments.

Vice-President

Symphony of Service

10th - Present

- Organize monthly concerts at 3 senior centers; coordinate with ~12 volunteers per performance.
- Logged 400+ collective service hours across events.
- Manage the student-to-senior letter-writing program.

Sunday Leadership Team Member

The Salvation Army

10th - Present

- Mentor ~20 low-income youth in piano through weekly lessons.
- Lead weekly Mandarin sessions for ~25 students, increasing their proficiency to a high school level.

Editor-in-Chief

Center for Teen Economic Education

11th - Present

- Lead the editorial team consisting of ~10 article writers; published ~20 articles. Mentor article writers on research depth, clarity, and style.
- Raised blog traffic ~50% through newsletter advertisements.

Journal Article Editor

Journal of Research High School (JRHS) & Questions Journal

10th - Present

- Review humanities/social-science manuscripts for clarity and citation ability.
- Provide line-edits and author guidance; only ~30% are published.
- Nominated for JRHS Junior Editor of the Year 2026.

Violin Instructor

Self-employed

9th - Present

- Taught 10 students total with personalized practice plans.
- Formed a student ensemble to busk, donating ~$500 in proceeds to charity.

Public Policy Fellow

Institute for Youth in Policy

12th

- Two-month fellowship (~6–8% acceptance) that built skills in policy analysis and writing. Collaborated on presenting policy problems & nonpartisan solutions.
- Presented and published individual capstone on US patent reform; awarded for "Outstanding Capstone."

Economic Policy Analyst

Institute for Youth in Policy

11th - Present

- Co-authored 4 nonpartisan economic policy briefs.
- Paid co-author on a published depolarization white paper for Business for America.

Teacher Assistant / Section Leader

Lamorinda Community Orchestra

9th - Present

- Lead first violin section (~15 players); plan and run monthly sectionals.
- Coach intonation, rhythm, musical phrasing, and concert-readiness skills.

Honors & Awards

Bronze & Gold Medal

The President's Volunteer Service Award

10th,11th

A prestigious national honor recognizing individuals and groups for their outstanding volunteer service and civic contributions in the United States. A result of 120+ (Bronze) or 250+ (Gold) hours of volunteering.

Honorable Mention

Horizon Academic Essay Prize

12th

A prestigious international essay competition judged by faculty from Yale, Harvard, Oxford, and Cambridge. Placed in the top 50 out of 1,952 entries (~2.5%) as an Honorable Mention.

Merit, High Commendation & Very High Commendation

John Locke Essay Competition

10th, 11th

Acknowledged as the world's most prestigious essay competition. Earned Merit for my 2024 History submission (top ~16%), High Commendation for my 2024 philosophy submission (top ~3%), and Very High Commendation for my 2025 philosophy submission (top ~1%).

Winner/Published

High School Fed Challenge

11th

Sponsored by the New York Federal Reserve. Provides students with the chance to build skills in teamwork, research, data analysis, and analytical writing. Produced original economic research published in the *Journal of Future Economics*.
Twelve out of 195 entries (~6%) are published.

Commendation

Marshall Society Essay Competition

11th

Organized by the Cambridge University Economics Society, inviting students to explore and write on challenging economic topics.
Forty-four out of 1,000+ entries (~4%) received Commendation or a higher award.

Finalist

Harvard International Economics Essay Contest

11th

Sponsored by the Harvard Undergraduate Economics Association (HUEA). Awardees demonstrate accomplished level of writing and understanding of economic theory.
Seventeen out of ~347 entries (~5%) received Finalist or a higher award.

Honorable Mention

Stossel in the Classroom Essay Contest

10th

The competition invites students to write essays on contemporary America, and is open to students in grades 5-12, residing in North America. Eighty-six out of thousands of entries received Honorable Mentions (~5%) or a higher award.

State Finalist & Maritime History Award

National History Day

11th

Students select topics and research them as historians. Over 1,600 students compete at the state contest each year. Only 15 students are selected as a finalist in the senior division at the state competition. Only student to be selected for the Maritime History Award in my division.

Third Place

Congressional Art Competition

11th

Sponsored by the U.S. House of Representatives. Allows high school students from across the country to showcase their artistic talents. Submitted pieces are judged on originality, skill, and artistic excellence.